standoff's size made its potential consequences even greater than those of Kargil.

THE 2001–2002 CRISIS

Kargil had been militarily and politically damaging to Pakistan. The operation cost Pakistan hundreds of soldiers, tarnished its international reputation, resulted in heightened civil-military tension, and failed to alter the regional balance of power.[76] But Pakistan and its proxies did not abandon their provocative behavior in the war's aftermath. Militants continued to flow from Pakistani Kashmir across the line of control into Indian territory. There they launched a number of serious terrorist incidents, such as hijacking an Indian Airlines aircraft and taking it to Afghanistan, and launching an October 2001 attack outside the Jammu and Kashmir Assembly. The violence culminated on December 13, 2001, when terrorists assaulted the Indian Parliament in New Delhi while it was in session. Although no members were harmed, five Indian security personnel died in a gun battle before the terrorists were killed.[77]

The Indian government determined that two Pakistan-backed militant groups, Lashkar-e-Toiba and Jaish-e-Mohammed, had carried out the assault. The result was a major Indo-Pakistani militarized dispute known as the 2001–2002 crisis. The crisis proceeded in two phases. During the first phase, in the immediate aftermath of the assault on Parliament, India launched Operation Parakram, mobilizing five hundred thousand troops along the line of control and the international border. The Indians simultaneously demanded that Pakistan surrender twenty criminals believed to be located in Pakistan, renounce terrorism, shut down terrorist training camps in Pakistani territory, and stanch the flow of militant infiltration into J&K. If Pakistan did not comply, the Indians planned to strike terrorist training camps and seize territory in Pakistani Kashmir. Pakistan responded with its own large-scale deployments, and soon roughly 1 million troops were facing each other across the LOC and international border.[78]